PLACEMENT PREPARATION

Summer Placements – Product Management 2023 Edition



SIGMA - The Product Management & Technology Club

IIM BANGALORE

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Atlassian

I. Samruddhi Zagade

Workex: *Software Engineer (Android Developer), 25 months*

Education Background: B. Tech, Information Technology

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: Workex requirement of >=24 months

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: Case submission followed by shortlisting and 2 rounds of interviews

The case-based questions revolved around the case submission. The case submission required was to list one feature that you like and one feature that you want to improve in any ride-hailing application.

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1: *Focus Area of Technical + PM Based behavioral / situational questions (about 60 mins)*

- Detailed discussion on case submitted and logic and inspiration behind everything that was mentioned.
- App critique and improvement for any app of your choice: Chose Spotify

  Refer to Sigma Casebook for the solution.

- How is a project estimated?

  Project estimation involves predicting the time, resources and costs required to develop and launch a new product or feature. A few key considerations while coming up with the estimate are product requirements, complexity of the product, the team's expertise, availability of resources (people, equipment) and risks. Some of the estimation techniques are:

- Top-down estimation: Starts with the overall project budget and allocates resources to different tasks and phases.
- Bottom-up estimation: Starts with estimation at task level and sums up the costs of all the tasks to get an overall estimate.
- Analogous estimation: Uses historical data from similar products to estimate costs of the product.
- Three-point estimation: Uses three estimates for each task- the optimistic, pessimistic, and most likely estimates. The final estimate is calculated by averaging the three estimates.

Note: This answer can be refined by giving examples from personal experience on the lines of the above points.

- Who are the stakeholders PMs interact with?

  Customers, users, business stakeholders (sponsors, executives), development team, marketing team, sales representatives, finance stakeholders, legal stakeholders.

- What team building strategies can PMs employ?

  A product manager is a leader with no authority but major responsibility and should be able to influence. Some of the team building strategies can be always ensuring clarity in goals and expectations, fostering communication and collaboration, resolving conflicts constructively, empowering team members, providing regular feedback and creating a positive work environment.

- Behavioral questions on work-ex

***Round 2**: Focus Area of Values and cultural fit (about 30 mins)*

This round revolved around Atlassian Values and Team Oriented behavioural questions.

- Can you tell an instance where you helped someone and created some impact on their life?
- Can you tell me an Instance when you failed?
- Can you highlight a situation where you handled multiple tasks?

Note: The answers should show individual traits as well as portray how good a team-player you are.

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: App Critique, Product improvement, PM roles like Estimation and Project Tracking, Feature Prioritization, Performance Metrics

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Case books: IIM A and B Case books
- Online resources: Exponent Videos and Website for cases and concepts, https://www.productmanagementexercises.com/
- Case discussions with peers
- Atlassian Culture and Values. https://www.atlassian.com/company/careers/resources/culture/humans-of-atlassian

  https://www.atlassian.com/company/careers/resources/interviewing/how-to-nail-your-product-interview

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Go through exponent videos and discuss cases with peers. Make sure that you put yourself into the habit of looking at all the stakeholders, finding the one with the most volume and digging deep into the problems they face, instead of directly thinking about features that might sound cool. Product-solution fit, and product-market fit are important aspects a PM needs to look after. Also look at frameworks like BUS, CIRCLES, etc. though you don't necessarily have to follow them as given. Do not make products for all the users, your product should be focused. You can read books like Design of everyday things, DC, etc. to get more ideas on designing good products.

And lastly, know your resume well.

II. Vaibhav Dhir

Workex: *Software Developer, 36 months*

Education Background: B. Tech, ECE

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: Workex requirement of >=24 months

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: Case submission followed by shortlisting and 2 rounds of interviews.

Case Submission - Pick a ride hailing app; highlight a standout smart product feature and an area of improvement.

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Introduction and basic background
- Favorite non-technical (daily life) product and its product design
- Motivation to pursue a product management role
- Why do you want to join Atlassian and what do you want from such a job

I was pushed to provide very specific answers to convey why I was interested.

Round 2*: Focused on Atlassian values and situational questions (around 45 minutes)*

- Situational questions around past failures, initiatives, losses, teamwork, and responsibility

It helped to be slightly vulnerable and finish every answer with what I took away from the situation. I asked for a minute to think and formulate my answer for some niche situations

Note: Go through company values and answer all situational questions in the STAR format

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Favorite Product, Product Design/Improvement

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Case books: Selected Sigma documents
- Online resources: Exponent videos, Stellarpeers
- Reference Books: Decode and Conquer
- Atlassian website resources

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Be clear with your experience, read properly on the companies you target to understand what you appreciate about them, watch Exponent (app critiques, guesstimates, and product design) videos. Don't overdo it, prefer creativity and adaptability over rigid frameworks.

Disney Hotstar

I. Aditi Kagane

Workex: *Lead Engineer, 35 months*

Education Background: B. Tech, IT

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: Workex requirement of >=12 months

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: Case submission on their own problem statement followed by 1 round of interview, which was focused on the case submission

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

The interview evolved around the case submission and other culture-fit questions

- Case Statement: Retain & engage subscribers post big sporting tournaments on Disney+ Hotstar. (Detailed Problem Statement: https://iimblr1.sharepoint.com/:b:/s/Sigma21-2322-24/EQb3CmsR14lNko2ZjWLWZn8BDuaGtGO8TQbb2yShhegWPg?e=8Kdmuz)

  You can include the following in your case solution

  - Problem Statement (articulate business and customer needs)
  - User Personas and target user persona, along with rationale for selecting the target user persona
  - Needs and pain points of the user persona
  - User journey
  - Features and their prioritization using frameworks like RICE, Value-Impact etc
  - Explanation of prioritized features with wireframes
  - Success Metrics
- There are so many companies coming today, why Hotstar?

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Product design, Success Metrics

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Case books: Sigma Case Book
- Online resources: Exponent videos

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Form a case group early and practice, make case submissions thoroughly

II. Rohith Pradeep

Workex: *Software Developer, 34 months*

Education Background: B. Tech, Electronics and Communication

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: Workex requirement of >=12 months

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: Case submission on their own problem statement followed by 1 round of interview, which was focused on the case submission.

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Basic introduction

  Mentioned briefly about my background i.e., educational qualifications, work experience and hobbies.

- Can you briefly tell how the suggested features can help in achieving the objective of the case study in the submission?

  The objective of the case study was to retain and engage customers post big sporting events. The features like personalized notifications, regional content promotion etc. will help to cater to all the entertainment needs in a single platform

- How did you decide the target audience for your solution?

I have developed user personas by conducting comprehensive user research, which included in-depth interviews, surveys, and observational studies. Then I segmented our audience based on behavioral patterns, needs, and goals. By analyzing this data and user journey, common characteristics and pain points were identified, which were then distilled into distinct personas. These personas served as a foundation for tailoring the solutions to address the specific needs and preferences of the target users.

- What approach did you follow for prioritizing the features?

  For different types of features, I have used a weighted scoring method based on how much value it will deliver to business and customers and how easy the method of creation is.

- How will you measure the success of your product strategy?

  Continuous monitoring of various success metrics like average time spent by customers, average number of clicks inside application, satisfaction rating etc. can be used for measuring success. It will also help in continuous improvement of the features based on the customer's evolving needs.

- What type of tools have you used for building the prototype (wireframes) of the product?

  I have used tools like Figma, Balsamiq etc.

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Target User persona, Feature prioritization, Success metrics

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Case books: Sigma Case Book and Preparation Book, IIMA PM Casebook
- Reference Books: Cracking the PM Interview

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans:

- If a problem is given, try to make an exhaustive set of stakeholders & address the issues associated with them.
- Product development concepts should be very clear.
- Get familiar with wireframing tools like Balsamiq

Google

I. Kanishk Vats

Workex: *Lead Engineer,51 months*

Education Background: B.E, Computer Engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: Workex requirement of >=36 months

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: 2-3 rounds of interviews (2nd round onwards were elimination rounds)

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Basic introduction
- Guess the amount of space required to store the photos in Google Photos.

  Refer to Sigma Casebook for the solution

- How can Google use Photos app to its advantage?

  I suggested the below features:

  - Training of Google AI based on Photos App.
  - Recommendations for vacation based on similarities of places visited.
  - Advertisement on Google Page based on Photo App pics uploaded.
  - Photos which do not violate privacy concerns can be used in Captcha's.

Round 2:

- Basic introduction
- Design a travel-based app considering the people have started traveling again after the pandemic.

  I followed the CIRCLES method to design the same. The personas considered were frequent travelers, business Professionals looking for a getaway, families going for vacations, international travelers. There were cross questions at every step as to why I chose a certain customer segment or why I chose a certain pain point to focus on.

Note: Make sure to justify your choices since you would be questioned on your thought process

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Guesstimate, Product Design

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Case books: Sigma Case Book and Preparation Book
- Online Resources: ProductSchool

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Be thorough with your knowledge of apps provided by Google apart from the famous ones like Photos, Meet, Drive.

II. Priyanka Kumari

Workex: *Senior System Engineer & Associate Product Manager, 51 months*

Education Background: B.E, Electronics and Communication Engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: Workex requirement of >=36 months

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: 2-3 rounds of interviews (2nd round onwards were elimination rounds)

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Improve Google Photos

  I followed the CIRCLES method to propose a solution. I was then asked to prioritize and suggest metrics. Two things to be mindful of -

1. At every stage, they will ask you to quantify (guess), such as - what do you think how frequently people will be using google photos.

2. For every metric, be mindful you explain in detail, such as instead of bounce rate, say bounce rate per day or per minute, instead of the number of users bounced or number active users bounced, say the active user is one who has used the platform at least twice and number of active users bounced per hour.

Round 2:

- Design a product for Delhi Metro

Refer to Sigma Casebook for the solution

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Product Design, Success Metrics

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans: Sigma Case Book and IIMB Case Book

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Though I have not read Decode and Conquer and Cracking the PM Interview, you can read them for more clarity of thought. Do watch YouTube videos such as Exponent. Have clear understanding of what a PM does, how an IT product works - frontend and backend [at a high level], and about recent technologies such as AI, AR, VR etc.

III. Stuti Jain

Workex: *Embedded software developer for IoT devices, 58 months*

Education Background: B.E, Electronics and Communication Engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: Workex requirement of >=36 months

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: 3 rounds of interviews (2nd round onwards were elimination rounds)

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1: Design a self-driving car for kids

Refer to Sigma casebook for the solution

Round 2: How will you design and measure the success of Gmail

Refer to Sigma casebook for the solution

Round 3: Design an alarm clock for the people who can't wake up.

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Product Design, Success Metrics

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Case books: IIM A and Sigma casebook
- Online Resources: Exponent, PM exercise questions

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans:

- Focus on understanding why a certain approach is followed in a case.
- Always stick to the framework, unless the interviewer specifies otherwise.
- Group discussions after the case help thing of more feature ideas as a group because that will help you have more features in the back of your mind before the interview.

IV. Subasini A

Workex: *Firmware Developer, 46 months*

Education Background: B.Tech, Computer Science

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: Workex requirement of >=36 months

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: 4 rounds of interviews (2nd round onwards were elimination rounds)

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1: Favorite Google Product: Chose GooglePay

- Why is GPay your favourite product?

  For me, checks all these boxes.

  - Usefulness – Gpay is useful, I can do P2P transactions, Merchant transactions & Bill payments
  - UX or ease of use – It has a fairly simple UI; I like that I can select a peer to send money to in a single click. Most other payment apps need at least two clicks (Search & selection of payee).
  - Fun aspects or delight factors – scratch cards / Diwali and IPL trivia / Collecting cards. A lot of gamification aspects made payments interesting.
- What's Google pay solving according to you? If you had to summarize in one statement

  I think Google wants to be in an all-in-one payments app. When people think of money, they should think of Google Pay. In one line - 'Money made simple'
- If you were a PM at google pay, what are the metrics that you would track?

  I am going to focus on end users, not merchants. (Used the AARRR framework)
  - Acquisition: Number of app installs (new & retained)
  - Activation: Number of users who make a payment (in-app or from other avenues such as Swiggy), Merchant transactions or Bill payments
  - Retention: Returning users who make a payment
  - Referral: No. of users sending a referral, no. of referrals each referee sends
  - Revenue: No monetization for end users
- Come up with a new feature for Gpay for fee payments

  I clarified that fee payments meant tuition payments to colleges
- Design a feature to make college tuition payments through gpay. Elaborate on how you will go about this.

  I would think about the payment methods to support. It could be just UPI but colleges like IIMB have a tuition fee of 4L+, which will hit the bank's UPI limit. So, we need to consider NEFT/IMPS and card payments. The next thing to consider would be checking if Google Pay should send reminders to the students to pay their fees.
  After we build the pilot version, we need to get feedback from the users.
  Google Pay could also suggest ways to finance this tuition fee once there is enough adoption.
- What is the Go-to-Market strategy for the above feature?

The first step would be to determine the target audience. I would start with the IIMs and ISB, then expand to other big brand schools, then to IITs and NITs & popular private colleges and so on.

The second step is to onboard colleges and convince colleges that this is a good payment method for them. We could initially start by providing a free payment gateway service to incentivize them to be onboarded. For the students, this will be a completely free feature.

Coming to the promotion of the feature, we can promote it with cashback. We can nudge students with reminders and a one-click path to the payment page from the push notification.

Google Pay can also use influencer marketing to promote this feature.

- What would be the north star metric for this feature?

  No. of payments successfully made

Round 2: Business model for drone delivery

I started with listing out all use cases for drone delivery, such as delivering meds, food delivery, package delivery etc. We picked the medicine delivery use case and explored it further.

Since this is drone delivery, we can limit our scope to OTC drugs first and later expand. I picked India as Geography focusing on Indian urban cities. We would drop the medicines at doorstep for individual houses, designated areas for apartment buildings.

- What are the partners you would tie up with?

  Tata 1mg, pharmeasy, Swiggy for crocin etc., Maps integration
- At Google, we do something called a pre-mortem. What are the things that could go wrong?
  - Drone malfunction: Drones are complex machines and can malfunction for a variety of reasons, such as mechanical failure, software errors, or bad weather. If a drone malfunctions while carrying OTC drugs, it could crash and the drugs could be damaged or lost.
  - Drone theft: Drones are valuable pieces of equipment and could be stolen, especially if they are carrying drugs that are in high demand. This could lead to the drugs being diverted to the black market or used for illegal purposes.
  - Data security: Drones that are used to deliver drugs would likely collect and store data about the delivery, such as the recipient's address and the type of drugs being delivered. This data could be hacked or stolen, which could lead to identity theft or other crimes.
  - Privacy concerns: Some people may be concerned about their privacy if drones are used to deliver drugs to their homes. They may worry that drones are being used to track their movements or collect information about their health.
  - Regulation: The use of drones to deliver drugs is not yet regulated in India. This means that there are no clear rules about how drones should be operated or who is responsible for their safety. This could lead to accidents or other problems.
  - Medicines could go into the wrong hands.
- How would you ensure that medicines don’t go to the wrong people?

Can do yes/no messages for delivery to the customer's mobile. The customer should be able to see the location of the drone and allow the drop to happen.

Round 3:

- During Covid, which industries do you think were poised for success and which were poised for failure?

  Poised for success: Technology firms: e-commerce, Communication, and collaboration platforms such as Zoom, food delivery, Companies such as Netflix and Amazon Prime, and Online education.

  Poised for failure: Travel and hospitality industry, entertainment (movies, malls etc.), Fashion (people did not buy a lot of clothes since they did not leave their homes), grooming (People didn't really care about how they looked)
- Now that you mentioned Zoom, can you think of what is missing in these tools compared to in-person interactions?

  Sure. Human connection was missing, and the reasons for this are mainly two – Most people tend not to turn on their videos on professional calls, and even when the video is on, we do not get to see each other's body language (pointed out how I could barely see the interviewer's face). We must rely only on verbal communication. The second aspect that is missing is that communication tends to be limited to work or whatever people are called for. When people go to the office, relationships are built over coffee chats and cracking jokes in meetings.
- Can you think of features that could improve connection?

  Mentioned one feature each in a personal and professional scenario

  I would like to think about two types of features – incremental improvements (Lights on features) and a moon-shot feature.
  - Incremental improvements for the personal scenario: People tend to order food or flowers for their loved ones when they are feeling down nowadays. We could detect the facial expression on the callee and prompt the user to do something like this. For example, "X looks like she is upset. Order her favourite food and make her day!"
  - Incremental improvements for the professional scenario: Gamify relationship building. A lot of teams in tech companies have an informal call every week to catch up with their co-workers. We could make this fun by adding games/quizzes about each teammate (we could take the data from Workday). For example, "In which city did xyz study?"
  - For Moonshots, I want to think about building something for the Metaverse – which simulates people's presence.
- Let's build a classroom in the Metaverse.

  Refer to Sigma casebook for the solution
- How can you ensure that some other large company won't copy your feature?

  Large companies have a lot of resources at their disposal & can easily copy the feature. We could try creating hardware dependencies and patent the IP.
- In the case of hardware, it cannot be quickly modified, how will you decide what should go into the HW?

  Most features should be allowed to be upgraded via software. Even at the hardware level, we can try pushing firmware updates that will improve the device.
- What would be the North Star metric for this feature?

  I think No. of hours spent learning could be a good North Star metric. It also considers the number of users indirectly.
- Product road map

Gave a detailed PLC product lifecycle from planning to launch.

Round 4: *HR focused round (about 10 mins)*

- *How do you think you will be able to contribute to Google?*
- You mentioned that Zoom was poised for success during Covid. Have you had a chance to think about your interview responses? Do you want to change your answer?
- What do you know about Google cloud?

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Favorite product, Product design, Go-to-market, Metrics, Roadmap

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Case books: Sigma casebooks, IIMA casebook
- Online resources: Exponent videos, Product school material
- Reference Books: Decode and conquer (gives you a basic idea about all the topics), Cracking the PM interview.

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans:

- Practice cases with friends and get feedback on each of the cases. Getting feedback is as important as doing the case.
- Follow tech trends and know interesting things happening in tech. Incorporating these into your answers makes your answers interesting for the PM interviewing you.

V. Varsha Shetty

Workex: *Software Engineer, 58 months*

Education Background: B.E, Computer Engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: Workex requirement of >=36 months

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: The first 2 rounds of interviews were scheduled before the placement week. We received an intimation regarding the interviews the day before and had a 45-minute slot scheduled for each interview. The third round onwards was during the placement week

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- The search bar on Google Maps has a reduced number of clicks. What could be the possible reasons?

  I confirmed that the search bar towards the top of the screen on Google maps, where we search for the required location, is seeing a reduced number of clicks.

  I started drilling down the cause by asking if the reduction was recent or gradual, if it was across Android and iOS, if there have been any changes in the Points of Interest like 'Hotels', 'Restaurants', 'Petrol' etc below the search bar in the app or a recent change in features.

  The response was that the reduction was gradual, over the last 2 months and there was no recent deployment (eliminating internal factors), apart from other factors (internal and external).

  I then considered a change in the way users use the app and mentioned that the reduction could be because users are directly navigating to the directions screen from an external link or from Google search, or better suggestions which is reducing the number of clicks. There was further discussion on this, in terms of explaining how I came up with this deduction.

- Design an in-car entertainment device.

  Refer to Sigma casebook for the solution

Round 2:

- Design an alarm clock for people who don't wake up.
- You're the PM of Twitter and Elon Musk has asked you to evaluate charging users for the blue tick.

  You can highlight the pros and cons of charging customers for the blue tick and state your opinion.

  Some pros: Revenue generation for Twitter, increased credibility, reduced impersonation

  Some cons: Loss of trust, increase in divide with respect to elitism, possible decrease in user engagement.

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Root Cause Analysis, Product Design

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Case books: Sigma PM Casebook and Preparation Book, IIMA and FMS Casebook
- Online Resources: PM School Explainer Series, Exponent Videos
- Reference Books: Cracking the PM interview, Decode and Conquer
- System Design Concepts from 'System Design Interview: An Insider's Guide' by Alex Xu (not needed anymore since Google doesn't ask System Design questions now)

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: It was a unique experience, and more of a discussion than an interview. The question would be open-ended, and you would have to make your assumptions and state it to the interviewer repeatedly. There would be no right answer, the interviewer would be interested in understanding your approach to the problem and the structure and would give you hints wherever needed. Make sure to explain your thought process at every step and seek validation from the interviewer.

Salesforce

I. Sneha Bhat

Workex: *Software Engineer, 35 months*

Education Background: B.E, Electronics and Communications

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: Workex requirement of 20-60 months

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: GD followed by one round of interview.

GD topic was - You are a Product Manager at Meta. How will you improve the meta eco system. What features will you introduce?

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- What kind of distribution channels are used for cloud/SAAS business
- How do you make a trade off in general about technology features and cost? What factors do you consider
- Workex related questions, Questions on Undergraduate project
- Workex questions on the product I worked on
- Industry knowledge of the cloud industry was tested
- Knowledge on AWS was tested
- How do you perform a make versus buy analysis? What are the factors considered for the same?

  Performing a make versus buy analysis is a critical decision-making process for a product manager when determining whether to develop a certain component or feature in-house or purchase it from an external vendor or partner.

  Following are the factors you should consider for make vs buy analysis :

  1. Define the Problem: Clearly define the component, feature, or service in question. Identify its scope, purpose, and required functionalities.

  2. Cost Analysis: Compare the costs associated with both options:

  a. In-House:

  - Direct development costs: labor, salaries, overhead, tools, equipment.

  - Indirect costs: training, management, infrastructure.

- Opportunity costs: resources diverted from other projects.

b. External Vendor:

- Licensing fees, subscription costs, or purchase price.

- Integration and customization costs.

- Maintenance and support costs.

3. Expertise and Resources: Assess the company's existing expertise and resources. Consider whether your team has the skills and capacity to develop and maintain the component in-house. If not, external options might be more efficient.

4. Time-to-Market: Evaluate the time required for both options. In-house development may take longer due to learning curves, development time, and testing. Purchasing from an external vendor could lead to a quicker time-to-market.

5. Quality and Control: Determine the desired level of quality and control. In-house development provides greater control over design, implementation, and customization. Purchasing may limit customization but might offer a more mature and reliable solution.

6. Strategic Alignment: Consider how the decision aligns with the company's long-term strategy, goals, and core competencies. Making in-house might provide a competitive advantage, while buying could free up resources for core activities.

7. Scalability: Evaluate the potential for scalability in both options. Will the chosen solution accommodate future growth and changes in demand?

8. Risk Assessment: Assess the risks associated with each option, including technical challenges, vendor reliability, data security, intellectual property concerns, and potential disruptions.

9. Total Cost of Ownership (TCO): Calculate the TCO for each option, which includes initial costs, ongoing operational costs, maintenance, upgrades, and potential switching costs.

10. Vendor Relationships: If considering a vendor, evaluate their reputation, financial stability, track record, and ability to provide ongoing support.

11. Flexibility and Customization: Determine the level of flexibility and customization required. In-house development offers greater customization options, whereas purchased solutions might have limitations.

12. Regulatory and Compliance Considerations: Check if the purchased solution complies with relevant industry regulations and standards.

13. Long-Term Viability: Consider the longevity of the solution. Will the vendor be around for the long term? Is the technology likely to become outdated quickly?

Remember that the make versus buy decision is not always binary. Hybrid approaches, such as developing a core component in-house and supplementing it with external solutions, can also be considered. The analysis process should be well-documented, involving input from cross-functional teams, and aligned with the company's strategic goals.

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Build vs Buy, Cloud technologies

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans: Case prep from Case books, You Tube channels and books relevant to PM.

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Try to connect with people in the industry for more information. Reach out via LinkedIn.

AppDynamics by Cisco

I. Varsha Shetty

Workex: *Software Engineer, 58 months*

Education Background: B.E, Computer Engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: Two rounds of product management oriented interviews followed by a discussion with the HR

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Why Product Management and my understanding of Product Management

  I spoke about how my background of cloud and big data aligns with their cloud observability platform, and my interest in Product management. Here the company-research and awareness about their recent products helped customize my answer to AppD.

- General discussion about work ex projects
- Say there is a company XYZ, the management has allotted a budget of $5 million to your business unit. You are responsible for finding the next business, i.e., identifying opportunities and allocating resources. What would your approach and next steps be?

  I began by clarifying the goal of the company through this, at this point - Increasing revenue, increasing adoption, etc. He asked me to choose as per my understanding.

  I mentioned that I had read that the cloud observability platform by AppDynamics is in its nascent stage. Considering this, I believed adoption would be an important goal. Other considerations would be working with design partners for future features and working on bug fixes in the released version.

- What would be your area of priority as a PM - bug fixes or new feature development

  Since the product is in its nascent stage, if the bug is blocking the goal i.e., adoption, that would be the highest priority. Post that, I would prioritize gathering customer feedback to design features for the next version of the platform.

- Questions for the panelist

  I asked a question about their cloud observability platform and the exact role of a Product Manager in their company (since the work of a PM differs across companies)

Round 2:

- Questions about my background and how it is relevant to their company and the role of a PM there.
- Which is your favorite UPI app - what do you like, what could the improvements be?

  This is a common question in interviews. It is recommended to prepare for this question and a few versions of it in advance (favorite app, favorite social media app, favorite physical product, etc.)

  Refer to the Sigma casebook for a sample on how to improve PhonePe

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Favorite Product, Understanding of the role of a PM

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Case books: Sigma Case Book and Preparation Book, IIMA and FMS Casebook
- Online resources: PM School Explainer Series, Exponent Videos
- Reference Books: Cracking the PM Interview, Decode and Conquer
- Company information (online as well as peers who have previously worked in the company)

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: It is helpful to know about the company's products and user feedback about it. I spoke to people in the company and read up about them and their new product - the Cloud Observability platform.

Walmart Global Tech

I. Sanchay Gupta

Workex: *Sr. Eng. Management Spl., 31 months*

Education Background: B.Tech, Computer Science and Engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: Workex requirement of >= 24 months

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: Two rounds of interviews

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Basic introduction
- Case Analysis on the cost structure of cloud migration project, what all needs to be taken care of, the cost and items

Round 2:

- Questions based on the resume, work experience, projects at college
- How can AI/ML be used at Walmart?

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: None

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans: Product Management Videos from YouTube, connections at Walmart

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Watch Amazons AWS system Design videos for various startups

InfoEdge

I. Jainesh Rathod

Workex: *Applications Developer, 45 months*

Education Background: B.E, Information Technology

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: Two rounds of interviews

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- "Walk Me Through Your Resume", followed by questions related to work-ex
- Favourite app, and its critique with potential improvements

  Refer to Sigma Casebook for examples

  It is suggested to find a few apps that they very often and study it from all possible angles, including certain limitations and improvements. It would be even better if you can have a favourite app for every category. For e.g.: Food delivery app Zomato, social media: Instagram and so on.

- Three Root Cause Analysis (RCA) questions

  Here the main aim was to test what all possibilities (internal and external) one can think of while keeping all the internal and external factors in mind.

  Some of the questions/ areas one can think of is:

  - Is the cause internal or external?
  - Is it across all platforms or limited to anyone? (e.g.: iOS, Android, WebApp, Desktop site, etc.)
  - Demographics?
  - Have metrics changed?
  - Any technical faults/bugs reported?
  - Is there a version change?

  Refer to Sigma casebook for examples of RCA Analysis / Diagnosis

Round 2:

- Can you provide a product overview of online classified platforms like OLX and Quikr?

  I started by clarifying that these are online classified sites which provide a platform to majorly buy and sell mainly used products.

  Looking at the User Personas and their user journey, users are both the buyers and sellers over here, which is traditionally defined as a marketplace.

  Buyer's user journey:

  - The buyer becomes aware of OLX and its products or services, logs into the website/ app, explores OLX to find products or services that meet their needs. They may use the search bar to find specific items, or they may browse through the different categories.
  - Transaction and negotiation: If the buyer decides to purchase a product or service from OLX. They contact the seller to negotiate the price and arrange a meeting.
  - Post-purchase: The buyer receives the product or service and evaluates their experience. They may leave a review on OLX to help another potential buyer

  Seller's user journey:

  - User Research and login: The sellers perform research on OLX to learn more about how it works and what features it offers and logs into the system
  - Decision: The seller decides to create an account on OLX and post an ad for their product.
  - Engagement: The seller interacts with potential buyers through the OLX messaging system.
  - Transaction: The seller completes the transaction with the buyer.
  - Post-transaction: The seller leaves feedback for the buyer and reviews the buyer's feedback.
- Give me any one key success metric for each part of your user journey you described.

  For Buyer:

  - Rate of user login abandonments / total visits to the app
  - Click-Through-Rate on listings
  - Searches per active user per month
  - Drop off rates to measures how many transactions are not successful
  - The number of customer complaints and Turn Around Time for resolutions.

  For Seller:

  - Rate of user login abandonments / total visits to the app too since it's a common app
  - Quality listings per user (Customized metric: Say complete self and product details with at least 3 postings)
  - No of two-way conversations
  - Drop off rates to measures how many transactions are not successful
  - No of transactions completed/day
- What do you think could be potential roadblocks?
  - There might be login issues.

  - The seller may be scammed/harassed by a buyer.
  - Not enough buyers for the product
  - Recommendations/listings not working for them
- Apart from CTR, any other metric for tracking why listings are not working?

  Conversion rate and revenue per click, to get a better understanding of the overall impact of recommendations.

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Favourite Product, Product Teardown

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Case books: Sigma Case Book and Preparation Book, IIMA Casebook
- Online resources: Exponent
- Reference Books: Cracking the PM Interview, Decode and Conquer
- Knowing more about the company and what products do they have is always a plus, though for me personally, the questions weren't company specific.

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans:

- When preparing for an interview for a product management role on campus, it is essential to know your resume well and be able to discuss your work experience and relevant projects in detail. Have a structured approach to your responses.
- To develop your skills and knowledge, practice PM cases with others who are also interested in the role, and study relevant products in every field you can think of. Practice from a wide variety of resources and try to cover all major type of PM Questions
- On the day of the interview, stay calm and self-assured, remembering that the campus placement is just one part of your journey. Don't let peer pressure influence your career choices, if you have prepared well, you have a good chance of getting the role.

II. Priyanka Kumari

Workex: *Applications Developer, 45 months*

Education Background: B.E, Information Technology

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: One round of interviews, the number of interview rounds varied across candidates

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Improve OLA

  Refer to Sigma Casebook for the solution

- Guess the number of flights in India.

  Refer to Sigma Casebook for the solution to a similar question

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Product Improvement, Guesstimates

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans: Sigma Case Book and Preparation Book, IIMA Casebook

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Though I have not read Decode and Conquer and Cracking the PM Interview, you can read them for more clarity of thought. Do watch YouTube videos such as Exponent. Have clear understanding of what a PM does, how an IT product works - frontend and backend [at high-level], and about recent technologies such as AI, AR, VR etc.

DP World

I. Ajeya Siddhartha

Workex: *Associate Consultant, 45 months*

Education Background: B.Tech, Computer Science

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: Three rounds of interviews (no GD)

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- You are the PM at LinkedIn, what metric will you use to gauge the success of LinkedIn's messaging feature?

  Explained Acquisition (monthly avg no. of users sending messages for the first time), Activation (DAU, MAU), Retention (churn rate) metrics for messages.

- You are the PM at LEGO. Children's interest in Lego's bricks have been declining. Design a product roadmap to launch a new digital product for them. He mentioned it can be any application or software where Lego's existing brand can be leveraged to come up with a product.

  Refer to Sigma Casebook for the solution

- What should be the optimizing function for a ride hailing app?

  Maximize Profit per km = Revenue – Cost.

  MECE on Revenue and Cost

Round 2:

- Design a product to solve the problem of long queues at Supermarkets

  Refer to Sigma Casebook for the solution

- Why do you want to be a PM and what is your Favorite app?

Linked it to my work-ex. Described the app. I was also asked about the monetization model of the app

Refer to Sigma Casebook for examples of favorite app

Round 3: HR Round

- What do you know about DP World?

  Named a few products, and other basic details.

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Metrics, Product design, Favorite app

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Case books: Sigma PM Casebook and Preparation Book
- Reference Books: Cracking the PM interview, Decode and Conquer

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Go through the material provided by PR mentors and solve cases with your peers

II. Aditya Adarsh

Workex: *Software Developer, 49 months*

Education Background: B.Tech, Computer Science

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: Two rounds of interviews

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Brief introduction
- Could you explain why you're interested in joining DP World?

  DP World is a global leader in logistics, and what appeals to me is their robust foundation in this field. Further by integrating cutting-edge technology, they have the potential to further elevate their logistical capabilities, resulting in more streamlined and efficient operations which is where I can bring my extensive experience of working in the field of Information technology.

- You mentioned your use of Google Analytics to improve website traffic. Could you share a detailed example of how you accomplished that?

  In one instance, we utilized Google Analytics to analyze user behaviour on our website. By identifying the pages with the highest bounce rates and the most common exit points, we were able to pinpoint areas for improvement. We then optimized these pages by enhancing content, improving user experience, and implementing targeted calls to action. This resulted in a significant increase in user engagement and a subsequent rise in website traffic.

- Let's move to a hypothetical scenario. Imagine there's an apple (fruit) supplier in Himachal Pradesh looking to reduce their carbon emissions. How would you approach this challenge?

  To address this, I would start by gathering detailed information about the supplier's operations and distribution channels. I'd like to inquire about the destinations they serve and the modes of transportation used. Once I have a comprehensive understanding, I would identify the key sources of carbon emissions, including transportation and packaging. Then, I'd explore alternative transportation methods, packaging materials, and potentially even regional distribution centers to reduce the carbon footprint. By optimizing transportation routes and adopting eco-friendly practices, we could work towards achieving the supplier's goal of carbon emissions reduction.

Round 2: HR Round

- Why DP World?
- State an instance how technology can be leveraged in the whole supply chain process.

  Answered that the last mile delivery can be optimized by observing the demand pattern from the consumer side.

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: None, it was more of a consulting and HR interview

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Case books: Sigma PM Casebook and Preparation Book
- Company's website and PPT, Recent news related to company

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans:

- Work on breaking the problem down as much as possible. Doing this will generate ideas automatically.
- Try to think from an end-customer viewpoint and not a manager's viewpoint, if you're working to design a product. That way you'll be able to think of many more diverse customer segments.
- Try to solve 2 cases daily, one individually and one in a group.

III. Siddhant Rohela

Workex: *Analog Designer, 46 months*

Education Background: B.Tech EE

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: Two rounds of interviews

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Monthly average users of FB going down, analyze the reason?

  I gathered the following information from the interviewer to understand the problem better

  - Time Frame: last 3 months
  - Problem restricted to reduction in existing users (new user onboarding rate assumed to be the same)
  - Problem was seen only on their app

I first discussed external reasons, then customer journey for internal reasons. There was no solution as such, she just wanted to know my thought process.

- How do you think they should retain their users?

  I described the different customer segments, and prioritized one (middle aged retirees, wanting to connect with long lost friends).

- Why invest in making FB better, when IG is already popular and growing?

  I said FB serves as a de-facto time capsule with features like life's milestones, photo albums, check-ins etc.: something which IG doesn't offer (because its purpose is different).

- Few hygiene questions about work experience
- Why PM? What is your understanding of a PM role? How is it different from program management? Was there such a role in your previous company? If yes, how did you use to interact with them as a designer? Finally, why did you leave your job/job-role?

Round 2:

- Pick any app of your choice and critically comment on it

  I chose Swiggy (had prepared for it beforehand). Explained the UI, functionality, where it did well, any feature that it didn't have, etc.

  Refer to the Sigma casebook for app critique questions

- Could you tell me about the design and design verification process in your previous company? Were there any important metrics that you used to work with?

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Root Cause Analysis, App Critique, Metrics

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Case books: Sigma preparation book for concepts, IIMA Casebook for case prep.
- Reference Books: Cracking the PM Interview
- Online Resources: A few app critique videos from Exponent on YouTube.
- Some latest tech news bits

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans:

- Work on clarity of the thought process, and do NOT force yourself to reach to the conclusion.

- Keep a backup option (another sector) in your plan, because the PM market looks really bleak at the moment.

IV. Vardhan Palli

Workex: *Project Engineer, 20 months*

Education Background: B.Tech, Computer Science Engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: Two rounds of interviews

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Introduce Yourself – Some follow-up questions
- Why Product Management?
- YouTube faces a lot of issues regarding copyright infringement, identify product improvements to solve the same.

  Talked about current techniques that are in place and how people go around them (modifying audio, speeding up the video, video in a video to imitate reaction videos as they are permitted). Identified ways that can catch these circumventions and tradeoffs if these ways are implemented.

  It was a highly qualitative discussion; the interviewer was mostly interested in how people circumvent the current rules placed by YouTube and the tradeoffs involved with the product features proposed.

- Develop an app for Tesla users.

  Started with CIRCLES framework but got interrupted and was asked to plot the user journey and identify what feature might be helpful at each step. Asked me to identify what can be a few added revenue streams that can be generated through the app.

- Amazon has seen a drop in sales across all regions in India, identify what might be the reason.

  I asked a lot of preliminary questions, and did an external analysis, the interview ended before I could complete the internal analysis, was just asked about the flow I would consider

Refer to Sigma Casebook for sample RCA / Diagnosis questions

Round 2:

- Why product management?
- Favorite feature in an app – chose Swiggy

Refer to Sigma Casebook for the solution

- How to make queues move faster in a supermarket?

The expectation was to come up with a product/software that helps in completing the checkout process at a supermarket faster.

Refer to Sigma Casebook for the solution

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Product Development, Product Improvement, Root Cause Analysis, App Critique

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Case books: Sigma casebook and preparation, IIMA casebook
- Reference Books: Decode & Conquer
- Online Resources: Exponent and PM School Youtube Channels
- Basic understanding of what the company does, recent happenings in the major field the company is present in.

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: PM Prep feels completely confusing at the start, you feel all over the place as you can't structure it like Consulting Prep. Just keep calm in the phase and power through the case books with your group, have app improvement/critique conversations as regularly as you can.

PhonePe

I. Ujwala Chintala

Education Background: B.Tech, Electrical Engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: GD followed by one round of interview

GD Topic: Digital payments infrastructure in India for 5 years and 5 years from now.

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Background of workex and education
- Questions around own startup like - How is your startup better than other players, what will you do if your competitor copies your idea etc.
- Scenarios based on things that could occur in the startup like "You get a bulk order for which your resources will not be sufficient to fulfil, what will you do", "Half time into the time given"

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: None, mostly revolved around the startup

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans: Case books and read about rapid-growing industries, current infrastructure etc.,

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Just practice problem solving skills and always be confident while answering the questions during interview. Just remember that everybody has a different way of solving problems and make sure you choose yours wisely. Frameworks like CIRCLES help a lot.

Kotak Mahindra

I. Prateek Kembhavi

Workex: *Software Engineer, 35 months*

Education Background: B.Tech CSE

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: One round of interview

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Brief introduction
- How to improve the banking process in general? Improve any UPI payments application as a product.

Refer to Sigma casebook for the solution.

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Product improvement

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Casebooks: Sigma Casebook and preparation book
- Prior interview experience from PGP2s

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: It's important to come prepared with PM concepts in the beginning itself. A brief amount of Consult Prep really paves the way for an easier PM Prep subsequently.

II. Pushpraj Kaushik

Workex: *Associate Consultant, 33 months*

Education Background: B.Tech, Mining engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: One round of interview

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Brief introduction
- Do you have financial applications on your phone? Which are the best financial applications you have, and do you use it frequently?

  Yes I have Kite (Zerodha) and Groww and I use them frequently

- Can you tell me a few things which you liked, and a few things you would like to improve about these products?

  Positives about Groww:

  - Groww is very easy to use
  - Mutual fund journey - If one wants to explore and invest in mutual fund it provides a holistic view and optimum amount of information is provided to go ahead so that way it's very appealing

  Negatives about Groww:

  - Stock journey - It is very cluttered, and they are trying to fit in a lot of information and graphs which makes the page overwhelming. If a mutual fund person wants to move to stock, they will find it difficult.
- How would you improve it?

  I explained how Zerodha has made a better stock journey and showed this information only when I want to see it. I need to click buttons to check graphs and other details otherwise it's just numbers and red- green to show profit or loss which is very intuitive. While answering these I covered the whole Zerodha journey and explained how dividend details, news, P&L, tax P&L everything can be viewed and analytics are also good.

- Any weakness which you would like to improve in zerodha ?

Not a drawback it may be the way they have positioned themselves, they put terminologies like you are already slightly better than a beginner and will understand the technical terms (maybe they want people to have some financial education I am just guessing from different talks of the founder)

- Do you know about neobanking? How do they earn money?

  They serve the customers which traditional banks don't. They lend to those underserved customers and then cross sell their loan or other high margin products and then earn profit from there.

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Product improvement

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Casebooks: Sigma Casebook and preparation book
- Reference books: Cracking the PM interview

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Prepare the basics and try to do end to end cases within time limit this will help to explain your idea clearly during interviews.

Optum

I. Vignesh L K P

Workex: *ML engineer, 34 months*

Education Background: B.Tech CSE

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: Workex requirement of >5 months

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: One round of interview

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

The questions were based on research during workex. The product in question was a travel time prediction system for public transport.

- How would you commercialize your research?
- What technology will you develop around the prototype?
- What are the factors to consider before coming up with a roadmap?
- How would you expand the scope of the product to target more customers/domains?
- Guesstimate to assess the target market size
- Questions on feature prioritization for the discussed product
- How would you accommodate dynamic feature requests from different stakeholders? What factors would you consider?

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Metrics, Feature prioritization, GTM

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Casebooks: Sigma Casebook, IIMA casebook from last two years
- Online Resources: YouTube playlists from Productschool, The Product Folks etc

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Develop product mindset, read news on forums like TechCrunch, digital news etc. to gauge interest then start interview preparation only if you like the domain. Talk to PGP2s and professionals in the PM space to get tailored advice and tips. Give a shot at PM competitions circulated by Sigma etc. to assess the community and competition

Samsung R&D

I. Darshan Pande

Workex: *Engineer, 58 months*

Education Background: BTech, Electrical and Electronics Engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: One round of interview

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Brief introduction and walk through your resume.
- Why product management?
- Why Samsung?
- Detailed discussion on workex roles and responsibilities.
- Favourite Product
  - How to improve user experience?
  - How will you improve the functionality of the product?
  - How will you measure success?
  - What metrics would you track for growth?
  - Strategy for monetization?
  - Metrics for monetization?

  There was cross-questioning at every stage to understand the line of thoughts and reasoning.

  Refer to Sigma Casebook for sample solutions of favourite product

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Favourite app and improvements, Metrics

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Casebooks: Sigma PM prep material
- Reference Books: Cracking the PM interview, Decode and Conquer

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Follow PM prep material given by Sigma diligently.

II. M Janani

Workex: *Software Engineer, 27 months*

Education Background: BE, Electronics and communication engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: One round of interview

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Brief introduction and questions based on workex and resume
- Why product management?
- Can you give a quick estimate on how many uber drivers are there in Bangalore?

  Refer to Sigma casebook for the solution

- Let's consider a new startup like Swiggy. There is a decline in sales. Explain about each stage of customer journey. Tell me about the possible reasons for less sales in each stage of the customer journey and relevant success metrics for the same.

  Refer to Sigma Casebook for the solution

- Basic HR questions

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Guesstimates, RCA

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans: IIMB Sigma case book

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: IIMB sigma case book and the preparation materials shared by the placement committee helped me in my preparation and I would recommend the same.

III. Jugal Makwana

Workex: *Software Engineer, 46 months*

Education Background: B.Tech, Mathematics & Computing

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: Two rounds of interview

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Brief introduction

  I mentioned my interest in FPL while talking about my hobbies. This led to some cross questions about my hobby. They asked me to elaborate about it further and I explained how it works.

- How do you make decisions while choosing your teams?

  I told them how I make decisions based on certain metrics and judge the teams accordingly. I also told them that I prepare a datasheet and analyse the data (I had worked on analytics during my UG project for a brief period of time).

- Can you create some metrics of your own, explain how they are calculated?

- How reliable are these metrics?

  Further deep-dived into each metric and explained how reliable and critical they could be while selecting the right team.

Round 2:

- Brief introduction and follow-up questions related to FLP once again.
- Which upcoming tech startups do you admire/ would like to evaluate?

  I told them that I admire Eightfold AI and spoke about some of their interesting work. I also gave them some information about how they evaluated CVs. This was followed by some cross questions and a brief discussion about what kind of work I would be given during the internship.

- Basic question about AI, ML and Deep Learning. Mostly their definitions and a few examples.

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: None

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Case books: Sigma Prep and Case books, IIMA PM cases
- Online References: Exponent videos

IV. Shaunak Soman

Workex: *Senior Engineer, 34 months*

Education Background: BTech, Computer Engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: Three rounds of interview

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Applications of multiple concepts related to marketing, economics and strategy
- Develop a marketing strategy for a product of your choice, for a new customer segment
- Follow-up questions on strategic implications, and economic factors affecting execution
- Design an app for blue collared workers
- Prioritize features listed with justification.

Round 2:

- Guess the number of autos in Bangalore

  Refer to Sigma casebook for similar examples on Guesstimates

- Suggest a feature for Uber Auto.
- The last 3 months have resulted in a drastic drop in Uber auto revenue collections. What could the reason be?

  It can be due to external or internal factors (Suggest doing MECE and following procedures similar to that followed in consulting interviews).

Round 3: HR Round

- *Brief introduction*
- *Basic HR questions*

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Product Design, Guesstimates, Go-to-market strategy, feature prioritization, Root cause analysis

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Casebooks: Sigma casebook and preparation book, IIMA casebook
- Online Resources: Exponent videos

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Keep calm, maintain consistency in your answers and structure all your thoughts. Back your answers with values or guesstimates wherever possible. The interviewers do not expect you to know everything. Practice frameworks with a diverse group of peers and also fine-tune generic questions.

Piramal Group

I. Mohamed Sarfraz M

Workex: *Technology Analyst, 34 months*

Education Background: BTech, Electrical and Electronics Engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: GD followed by one round of interview

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Design a dashboard that can be used by loan officers (Sales Team) to segment the customer market and track their progress?

  Customers can be segregated based on the following-

  - Demographics
  - Branch from which they got the loan
  - Type of loan (Home loan, gold loan etc)
  - Amount of loan
  - Loan period
  - Income level of customer
  - Credit rating, CIBIL scores

  Different visualization charts can be used to depict these segments and data can be updated in real time. This dashboard can be used for cross selling of loan products. Also, salespeople can be allocated accordingly.

- What kind of information will be displayed on the dashboard?

  Different banking metrics can be displayed. Like how much interest is earned per customer. Average no. of days taken for interest payments; Loan amount disbursed per branch. # of loans per sales personnel, Customer default rate, NPAs, time taken for a loan to be classified into NPA

- Which metrics will be of primary importance in the dashboard?

of daily active users, average session time, user satisfaction, # of actions/ clicks performed by the user

- How can finance companies use analytics?
- Do you know about regression techniques? Explain
- Questions around work experience and kind of tools/technologies used in the job.
- How comfortable are you with SQL/Python and do you have any work experience in these areas?
- What do you know about Piramal Group?
- Current affairs about Rishi Sunak taking over as UK PM

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Dashboard creation, Metrics/KPIs

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Casebooks: Sigma casebook and preparation book
- Company website and JD

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans:

- Go through the Sigma case book but don't limit to only that. Check other websites, Youtube videos for mock case interviews
- Have good communication skills

Pine Labs

I. Arun Nair

Workex: *Product Manager, 21 months*

Education Background: BTech, Electronics and Communication Engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: GD followed by one round of interview

GD topic: Build a financial app for teenagers. As part of discussion, went through full product design flow

Refer to Sigma Casebook for the solution

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Brief introduction
- Questions based on resume

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: None, the interview was based on the resume

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Casebooks: Sigma casebook and preparation book
- Online Resources: PM School Explainers on YouTube

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Start early. Unforeseen circumstances could reduce prep time closer to the placements. We also did PM prep before consulting prep which seemed to work for us.

Just Dial

I. Khathavath Sridhar

Education Background: BE, Civil Engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: One round of interview

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Google Maps is displaying a shorter ETA than is required to travel between two points. Users are reporting that they are arriving at their destination later than expected, even when they follow the directions provided by Google Maps. What could the causes be?

  I gathered the following information based on discussion with the interviewer.

  - The problem is present be across all platforms, Android/iOS, Mobile/Web
  - It has only been seen in the last couple of days.
  - Google recently pushed an update.

  Possible causes

  - Google Maps uses an incorrect or outdated map.
  - Google Maps does not consider traffic conditions.
  - Google Maps is not considering the speed limit.
  - Google Maps shows the ETA based on the air route rather than the road route.

  The problem was that ETA was based on the air route.

  Solution to the problem: Immediately push a software update that reverts the last update for ETA calculation.

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: RCA / Diagnosis

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Casebooks: Sigma casebook and preparation book
- Online Resources: Exponent videos

II. Vishal Shakya

Workex: *Project Engineer, 48 months*

Education Background: BTech, Mechanical Engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: One round of interview

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Brief introduction
- Could you tell us why you decided to pursue a career in Product Management?
- Since you mentioned an interest in technology, could you elaborate on what global digital changes you are following and how they are impacting industries?

  The rise of Bitcoin and blockchain technology is transforming the financial sector by introducing decentralized and secure transactions. Meanwhile, 5G technology is set to revolutionize communication and enable the growth of IoT devices and applications across industries, from healthcare to manufacturing.

- Questions related to workex: responsibilities, significant contributions, design platforms utilized, analysis process followed?
- Which payments app do you use for day-to-day transactions?

I use both Paytm and Google Pay for making payments, but often prefer using Paytm.

- Could you explain the differences between these platforms and why you prefer Paytm?

  Both platforms offer convenience, but I find Paytm more versatile due to its wider acceptance at various stores and services. I prefer it over Gpay because of its extensive partner network, making it easier for me to transact across different domains. Moreover, Paytm has a

more intuitive user interface, and thus easier to use apart from offering better visibility of rewards that makes it more engaging for users than Gpay. However, Gpay has a lower processing time than Paytm which makes it more favourable for some users.

- What strategies do you believe are effective in drawing customers to a platform?

  To attract customers, bundling services, offering discounts, and implementing targeted marketing campaigns can be highly effective. Providing additional value and meeting specific needs creates a compelling proposition for users.

- How would you prevent customers from switching to a different platform once those attractive elements end?

  Preventing switching involves introducing switching costs, making it less convenient for users to migrate. If a platform offers unique features, integrated services, or personalized experiences that users have invested time in, they'll be less likely to switch even if competing platforms offer similar services.

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: None

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Casebooks: Sigma casebook and preparation book
- Product GD preparations with people who had work-ex in Product Management

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans:

- Be prepared with whatever you have done in your workex & if there is any problem solving, design related activities you have done then give more focus on revising or framing of that.
- Have an understanding of 4-5 products, how they are different from similar products available in market.
- If a problem is given, try to make an exhaustive set of all the stakeholders & address the issues associated with them.
- Product development concepts should be very clear.
- During interviews, focus more on approach rather than arriving at the right answer.
- The killer Tip....Be attentive, genuine & Cool during PI!!

Eightfold AI

I. Priyanka Kumari

Workex: *Senior System Engineer, 51 months*

Education Background: BTech, Electronics and Communication Engineering

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: One round of interview

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Brief introduction
- Design a meeting scheduler app for HR professionals, prioritize features and suggest metrics to evaluate success.

  Be mindful of the whole customer journey and need at each level. A suggestion is to be thorough with the company's products, business model and what problem they are exactly trying to solve.

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Product Improvement, Feature Prioritization, Metrics

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans: Sigma casebook and preparation book, IIMA Casebook

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Though I have not read Decode and Conquer and Cracking the PM Interview, you can read them for more clarity of thought. Do watch YouTube videos such as Exponent. Have clear understanding of what a PM does, how an IT product works - frontend and backend [at a high level], and about recent technologies such as AI, AR, VR etc.

II. Tridib Roy

Workex: *Senior Product Analyst, 34 months*

Education Background: BTech ECE

Q1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Ans: None

Q2. What was the hiring process (GD / Submissions / Interview Rounds)

Ans: Two rounds of interview

Q3. What were the questions asked in the interview rounds?

Ans:

Round 1:

- Brief introduction
- Questions around past work experience as a Product Manager: intention behind decisions taken as a PM, ways in which a task could be done, etc
- Favourite product: I chose YouTube since I am also a creator at YouTube

Refer to Sigma casebook for the solution

Round 2:

- Questions about past work experience
- Product design for their own product - A LinkedIn extension to scrape profiles and run their AI to post process HR applications automatically.
- Culture fit questions

Q4. What were the PM topics covered in the GD/Interview?

Ans: Favourite Product, Product Design

Q5. What resources did you use to prepare for PM and for company specific information?

Ans:

- Online Resources: PM Folks, Growth X newsletter, LinkedIn posts (follow good influential PMs)
- Past work experience, group discussions with peers

Q6. Do you have any other tips / suggestions for aspiring PMs?

Ans: Prepare from PM Folks and follow people on LinkedIn.